

Problem of Can't set locale; make sure \$LC_* and \$LANG are correct!

Asked 9 years, 10 months ago Modified 5 years, 7 months ago Viewed 155k times

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When I always try to install new package I get this message:

```
Can't set locale; make sure $LC_* and $LANG are correct!
perl: warning: Setting locale failed.
perl: warning: Please check that your locale settings:
    LANGUAGE = "en_GB:en",
    LC_ALL = (unset),
    LC_CTYPE = "en_GB.UTF-8",
    LANG = "en_US.UTF-8"
are supported and installed on your system.
perl: warning: Falling back to the standard locale ("C").
locale: Cannot set LC_MESSAGES to default locale: No such file or directory
locale: Cannot set LC_ALL to default locale: No such file or directory
```

My OS is Debian Jessie 8.3 (Mate) using English with French keyboard. When I type locale, I get this:

```
locale: Cannot set LC_MESSAGES to default locale: No such file or directory
locale: Cannot set LC_ALL to default locale: No such file or directory
LANG=en_US.UTF-8
LANGUAGE=en_GB:en
LC_CTYPE=en_GB.UTF-8
LC_NUMERIC="en_US.UTF-8"
LC_TIME="en_US.UTF-8"
LC_COLLATE="en_US.UTF-8"
LC_MONETARY="en_US.UTF-8"
LC_MESSAGES="en_US.UTF-8"
LC_PAPER="en_US.UTF-8"
LC_NAME="en_US.UTF-8"
LC_ADDRESS="en_US.UTF-8"
LC_TELEPHONE="en_US.UTF-8"
LC_MEASUREMENT="en_US.UTF-8"
LC_IDENTIFICATION="en_US.UTF-8"
LC_ALL=
```

debian locale

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edited Mar 11, 2016 at 17:06

 **Jeff Schaller** ♦
68.9k ● 35 ● 122 ● 268

asked Mar 11, 2016 at 13:27

 **Ismail Sensei**
1,269 ● 3 ● 11 ● 13

5 Answers

Sorted by:

Highest score (default) ⌵

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Debian ships locales in source form. They need to be compiled explicitly. The reason for this is that compiled locales use a lot more disk space, but most people only use a few of them.

Run `dpkg-reconfigure locales` as root, select the locales you want in the list (with your settings, you need `en_GB` and `en_US.UTF-8` — I recommend selecting `en_US` and `en_GB.UTF-8` as well) then press `<OK>`.

Alternatively, edit `/etc/locale.gen`, uncomment the lines for the locales you want, and run `locale-gen` as root.

(Note: on Ubuntu, this works differently: run `locale-gen` with the locales you want to generate as arguments, e.g. `sudo locale-gen en_GB en_US en_GB.UTF-8 en_US.UTF-8`.)

Alternatively, Debian now has a package `locales-all` which you can install instead of `locales`. It has all the locales pre-generated. The downside is that they use up more disk space (112MB vs 16MB).

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answered Mar 12, 2016 at 1:27

 **Gilles 'SO- stop being evil'**
867k ● 205 ● 1.8k ● 2.3k

2 It worked, but only after I logged out and then logged in again. – [Forivin](#) Aug 16, 2017 at 8:10

Worked for me too! – [MuffintopBikini](#) Apr 4, 2018 at 19:57

21/01/2026, 05:45

debian - Problem of Can't set locale; make sure \$LC_* and \$LANG are correct! - Unix & Linux Stack Exchange

editing /etc/locale.gen doesn't did the job for me (did logout/login), but locale-gen solved my tmux: need UTF-8 locale (LC_CTYPE) problem on Debian 4.9.82 – eapo May 30, 2018 at 21:59

2 @eapo As I state in my answer, you need to edit /etc/locale.gen and then run locale-gen . – Gilles 'SO- stop being evil' May 30, 2018 at 22:30

I missed the bit about enabling en_US.UTF-8 as well and your own locale. I found out the hard way then circled back here to make my own answer before realising it was here all along. – Alastair McCormack Feb 9, 2019 at 18:49

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The top-rated solution didn't help in my case, so I used this one:

```
export LC_ALL="en_US.UTF-8"
sudo dpkg-reconfigure locales
```

After that, I logged out and logged in and error was missing.

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edited Jun 11, 2020 at 10:45

answered Mar 23, 2017 at 8:22

 Andhi Irawan
107 4

 ssasa
611 6 7

3 Using LC_ALL is strongly discouraged as it overrides everything. Please use it only when testing and never set it in a startup file. as per: wiki.debian.org/Locale – Pitone Maledetto Jan 26, 2018 at 9:29

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If you're having this issue on a raspberry pi (or other?) and you're getting the error when you ssh to the pi there are 2 other solutions

One is edit /etc/ssh/sshd_config on the pi and comment out the line

```
AcceptEnv LANG LC_*
```

for example `sudo nano /etc/ssh/sshd_config`

After which you should restart the ssh server

```
sudo systemctl restart ssh
```

The other is on your client machine (**not the pi**) edit /etc/ssh/ssh_config (different path from above) and comment out the line

```
SendEnv LANG LC_*
```

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answered Aug 24, 2018 at 4:32

 gman
260 2 8

Both of these are uncommented for me but problem still arises. (RPi3, macOS10.14) – gosuto Oct 9, 2018 at 6:30

Commented *out* the line now. Don't really have the opportunity to test but sounds more logical this way... Thanks. – gosuto Oct 9, 2018 at 15:38

Works on raspberry pi with Debian 10 . What is the idea? Throwing away locale settings in a ssh session that is sent from the client host. – Timo May 15, 2021 at 15:09

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These commands saved my life

```
# echo "LC_ALL=en_US.UTF-8" >> /etc/environment
# echo "en_US.UTF-8 UTF-8" >> /etc/locale.gen
# echo "LANG=en_US.UTF-8" > /etc/locale.conf
# locale-gen en_US.UTF-8
```

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edited Mar 28, 2018 at 23:00

answered Mar 18, 2018 at 19:46

 multithr3at3d
542 3 14

 Taras Vaskiv
249 2 5

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You need to install the package locales (or locales-all or the en_GB locale, depending on the Debian version you have).

A workaround not to have such errors: set LANG=C to root, so that it will use no locales.

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answered Mar 11, 2016 at 13:33





Giacomo Catenazzi

3,031 12 18

Someone may end up in here. for my case, the error was `-bash: warning: setlocale: LC_ALL: cannot change locale (en_US.UTF-8)` and running `sudo locale-gen en_US.UTF-8` fixed my issue. Source: stackoverflow.com/a/75688055/2190689 – ssi-anik Jan 28, 2025 at 17:31

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